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GraphCalc: A Python Package for Computing Graph Invariants in Automated Conjecturing Systems

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Software

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Summary

`GraphCalc` is a lightweight Python library for efficiently computing a wide range of graph invariants using linear and integer programming optimization models. It plays a central role in the **TxGraffiti** family of automated conjecturing systems, where it serves as the primary computational engine for generating data-driven mathematical conjectures in graph theory. The package provides accessible tools for calculating over 50 graph invariants, including many NP-hard parameters—such as the chromatic number, the independence number, and various domination numbers—through optimized formulations that leverage modern solver technology.

Statement of Need

Modern research in graph theory and network science often requires the rapid and accurate computation of multiple graph invariants across large datasets of graphs. While general-purpose libraries such as NetworkX (Hagberg et al., 2008) and igraph provide essential tools for graph traversal and manipulation, they typically lack built-in support for computing structurally significant and computationally difficult invariants—especially NP-hard parameters like the independence number, chromatic number, or various domination numbers.

`GraphCalc` addresses this gap by providing a unified, research-oriented interface for computing both classical and advanced graph invariants. Many of these quantities are computed using carefully designed linear and integer programming models, enabling exact solutions where possible and practical approximations where needed. The package is purpose-built for integration into automated conjecturing frameworks, including TxGraffiti (Davila, 2025a) and its successors (such as the Optimist (Davila, 2025b)), which rely on accurate and reproducible invariant computations across thousands of graphs to generate and evaluate mathematical conjectures.

Features

`GraphCalc` supports both `NetworkX` graph objects and its own built-in graph types. This dual compatibility allows users to take advantage of familiar graph creation tools while benefiting from specialized features and optimizations specific to `GraphCalc`'s native graph representations.

- **Core invariants**: Computes over 50 classical and advanced graph invariants.
- **Graph filters**: Boolean functions to test properties like planarity, connectivity, and claw-freeness among many others.
- **Documentation and testing**: Full online documentation, type hints, and unit test coverage.

Example Usage

```python
import graphcalc as gc

G = gc.petersen_graph()
gc.chromatic_number(G)       # Output: 3
gc.independence_number(G)      # Output: 4
gc.connected(G)           # Output: True
```

Relevance to Automated Discovery

`GraphCalc` is not merely a utility—it is a foundational component in the emerging field of automated mathematical discovery. Systems like **TxGraffiti** (Brimkov et al., 2024) depend on high-quality numerical data to identify potential relationships among graph invariants. These conjectures—often involving complex parameters such as independence number, domination number, or matching number—are generated by detecting patterns in the invariant data computed by `GraphCalc` (Caro et al., 2022).

The accuracy, consistency, and scope of these computations are critical. An automated conjecturing agent is only as good as the data it learns from—and in this context, `GraphCalc` serves as the lens through which structural graph properties are measured, compared, and ultimately hypothesized upon. By supporting exact computations through integer programming and offering broad invariant coverage, `GraphCalc` makes data-driven mathematical reasoning possible at scale.

As AI tools continue to play a growing role in formal mathematics, `GraphCalc` stands as a key enabler for systems that not only process graph data but also help generate new mathematical knowledge.

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